

Hacking Attack On A Government Web Site

The Web site of the Government of Maharashtra was hacked and defaced in September. The hacker(s) used at least five proxy servers to get in, so the probability of tracing the hacker(s) is very low. The Cyber Crime Cell of the Crime Branch traced one of the proxies to Washington DC

Hacked!

Key-loggers in all Mumbai Internet cafés!

Mumbai Police are planning to force cyber-café owners to install key-logger software. (The explosions in Hyderabad and Mumbai appear to have been planned in Internet chat rooms. Café owners must register at police headquarters, and log the IP address of every PC!



Enter



Yeo Eng Yiong

Senior Manager

iPod Product Marketing, Asia Pacific

Apple recently launched the iPod Touch—amongst other iPod versions—in India. We asked Yeo Eng Yiong, senior manager for iPod product marketing for the Asia Pacific region, some quick questions.

Do you have any plans to market the iPod with local content and language options, like in the EU?

With the iPod, you can listen to an almost unlimited number of podcasts via iTunes. As of now, we have quite a few India-centric podcasts which can be downloaded via iTunes or from the Internet.

As far as local language settings for menus on the phone, we believe that since the iPod uses iTunes to sync songs to and from the player (and has no Indian language options either) this should not be a shortcoming.

What's the difference between iPods for Asia and for the rest of the world?

The earpieces of headphones sold with iPods in Asia are smaller than their counterparts in the EU and America. The Asian market is dominated by Flash-based music players that have an inexpensive, plastic feel to them. The iPod, on the other hand, has a stainless steel body with a metallic finish at its back that adds to its appeal. We also noticed that the stainless steel back cover makes the design and overall feel of the iPod classy which attracts more buyers.

Why is the iPod Touch only available in 8 and 16 GB models, when it is geared at watching video on a wide screen?

We wanted to continue to maintain the slim form factor with the iPod Touch. Having a hard drive would only increase its size. Moreover, a hard drive would consume more battery.

IT'S GOT TO END SOME TIME

Moore Wraps Up Own Law

It's probably the most famous Law of our times and of our interest: Moore's Law, which states that the number of transistors that can be (inexpensively) placed on an integrated circuit will increase exponentially, doubling approximately every two years. It wasn't declared as a law, and by its nature, it cannot be a "law." Still, it's been working like one: your processors keep getting cheaper with impeccable regularity.

Now, Gordon Moore, the man behind the Law, has stated that there are fundamental limits to it; that the laws of physics will soon render it obsolete. The original statement having been made in 1965, the rate has held true thus far. Moore now gives it ten to fifteen years more.

What's interesting here is that the man is saying it himself. You see, questions about it have been asked almost every third day: "Will Moore's Law continue forever?" "When will Moore's Law end?" Those questions have now been formally buried.

In any discussion of this landmark announcement, three points must be made. First, it's obvious that it had to end some time. Second, he's said it before—though not as officially. Third, the announcement can be



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

misconstrued to mean "we won't see faster, cheaper computers any more."

As regards our first point, think about the Law, and you'll realise there *has* to be a limit to its applicability—you can't keep going smaller and smaller. "Any physical quantity that's growing exponentially predicts a disaster," Moore said. "You simply can't go beyond certain major limits." But technologists have been pushing those limits for long—and Moore has said he's been "perpetually amazed" at that.

Now, back in 2003, Moore had already said about that the fact that materials are made of

atoms is a limit that, obviously, can't be argued with. He went on to talk about "bigger chips" being made, and that things could slow down to "every four years" instead of "every two years." Both points were only digressions, but they show that he'd hinted earlier at The End—so this pronouncement shouldn't come as much of a surprise now.

Finally, talking about how progress will be made regardless, we could see other technologies—such as nanotech—enabling such things as the speeding up of transistors. In fact, nanotube transistors have already been demonstrated. Then, as we've spoken about before in *Digit*, there's DNA computing, quantum computing, and reversible computing coming onto the scene.

In any case, the current excitement is about the "every-two-years" figure, the figure that's been drilled into our heads. *That* number is on its way out.

The technologies have changed. It's now not just about packing more transistors onto a chip. There are just too many variables, too much innovation—there might never be a Law again, one that so accurately predicts technological progress.